



Develop and implement a business plan

D1.HCS.CL6.05

D1.HSM.CL5.06

D2.TRM.CL9.02

Assessor Manual



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Assessor Manual

Project Base

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Table of contents

Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors.....	1
Competency standard.....	11
Oral questions.....	23
Written questions	31
Answers to written questions	37
Observation checklist.....	47
Third Party Statement.....	51
Competency recording sheet	55

Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):

"At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.

These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:

You are required to complete these activities:

- Using the 'X' method of assessment*
- At 'X' location*
- You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*

You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment

Do you have any questions about this assessment?"

- Commence Work Project assessment:

The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions

Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format

Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
Enter Student name
Enter Assessor name
Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):

"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment

Do you have any questions about this assessment?”

- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:

Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:

- a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
- b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
- c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

The due date for completion of this assessment is X

On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X

Do you have any questions about this assessment?”

- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
Pass Competent = Yes
Not Yet Competent = No
Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: DEVELOP AND IMPLEMENT A BUSINESS PLAN		NOMINAL HOURS: 60
UNIT NUMBER: D1.HCS.CL6.05 D1.HSM.CL5.06 D2.TRM.CL9.02		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to develop and implement a business plan in a range of settings within hotel and travel industries		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA	UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE	
Element 1. Analyse the internal and external business environment 1.1. Determine information requirements and undertake <i>research</i> to deliver <i>relevant information</i> 1.2 Consult with all internal and external <i>stakeholders</i> in the research process 1.3 Use research to assist in the prediction of social, political, economic and technological <i>trends and developments</i> 1.4 Identify and seek <i>assistance and advice</i> from <i>appropriate experts</i> when necessary 1.5 Review and analyse the existing internal <i>resources and capabilities</i> 1.6 Document and analyse business opportunities and obstacles based on valid and reliable <i>comparative market information</i>	Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment This unit applies to developing and implementing business plans within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Front Office 2. Housekeeping 3. Food and Beverage Service 4. Food Production 5. Travel Agencies 6. Tour Operation <i>Analyse of the internal and external business environment</i> should include • Capabilities and resources • Human resources	

1.7 <i>Review and analyse current and emerging competitors</i> for their potential impact Element 2. Formulate business plans and strategies 2.1 Create or confirm enterprise mission, vision and purpose as the starting point for the <i>business plan</i> in consultation with stakeholders 2.2 Establish realistic, clearly stated and measurable <i>objectives</i> for the business 2.3 Develop appropriate <i>strategies</i> and tactics to address objectives across all <i>areas of business operation</i> 2.4 Identify and include opportunities for strategic business alliances 2.5 Develop all aspects of the business plan to ensure the business meets relevant legal, social, environmental and ethical obligations 2.6 Include appropriate action plans and <i>evaluation processes</i>, including key <i>performance indicators</i> 2.7 Consult with appropriate staff, management and other stakeholders to encourage support for the planning process so that all perspectives are taken into account in the development of the plan	• Financial resources • Equipment capacity • Staff skill levels • Hours of operation • Communication capabilities • Location/position • Trends and developments in the marketplace such as: ▪ Economic ▪ Ecological/environmental ▪ Government activities ▪ Social and cultural ▪ Demographic ▪ Technological ▪ Industrial • Comparative market information • Best practice information • Benchmarking • Competitor information • Legal and ethical constraints • Legislation • Regulation
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Element 3. Implement the business plan 3.1 Communicate the <i>business objectives</i> and content of plans in a timely manner to facilitate a clear understanding of the plan and associated activities and individual responsibilities 3.2 Use appropriate leadership techniques to <i>encourage team commitment</i> to the business plan 3.3 Encourage staff to provide ongoing input into the business plan 3.4 Implement and organise actions detailed in the plan in a cost-efficient manner and in accordance with schedule and <i>contingencies</i>	• Codes of practice • Cultural expectations and influences • Social responsibilities, e.g. Protection of children and environmental issues. <i>Research</i> may include: • Interviewing colleagues and clients • Focus groups • Data analysis • Product sampling • Documentation reviews. <i>Relevant information</i> may include: • Current performance data • Sales and contracts • Forecasted trends and opportunities • Available resource commitments and capacity.
Element 4. Monitor the business plan 4.1 <i>Review the business plan</i> regularly and adjust in the light of changing circumstances 4.2 Monitor activities detailed in the plan on an ongoing basis 4.3 Identify and analyse successes and <i>performance</i> gaps on an ongoing basis 4.4 Implement agreed changes to plans promptly 4.5 Report performance in a transparent manner to all stakeholders	<i>Stakeholders</i> may include: • Customers • Employees • Government agencies • Owners • Suppliers • Strategic alliance partners.

	<i>Trends and developments may be</i> • Economic • Ecological/environmental • Government activities • Social and cultural • Demographic • Technological • Industrial. <i>Assistance and advice from appropriate experts may be sought for:</i> • Facts and information, e.g. Copy writer, journalist, researcher • Legal or financial advice, e.g. Solicitor, accountant. <i>Resources and capabilities may include</i> • Human resources • Financial resources • Equipment capacity • Staff skill levels • Hours of operation • Communication capabilities • Location/position • E-business capacity.
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	<i>Comparative market information</i> may include: • Best practice information • Benchmarking • Competitor information. <i>Review and analyse current and emerging competitors</i> may relate to: • Volume • Price • Territory • Customer accounts • Trading terms • Market share • Customer satisfaction. <i>The business plan</i> may be for: • A new small business venture • An existing small business • A division or department of a large organisation • A new product development initiative. <i>Objectives</i> may include: • Sales figures • Revenues • Delivery times • Service standards
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	• Client numbers • Client handling times • Staff turnover • Profit margins. <i>Strategies</i> may include: • Client development • Geographic expansion • Organisational growth • Service growth • Debt reduction • Income development. <i>Areas of business operation</i> in the business plan should include: • Operations • Marketing • Technology • Human resources/labour requirements • Management and organisational structure • Financial plan and projections • Quality management. <i>Evaluation processes</i> may include: • Key performance indicators • Gap analysis
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- Customer feedback
- Compliance reports
- Employee feedback.

Performance indicators may include:

- Sales
- Return on investment
- Customer service
- Debt servicing costs.

Business objectives may include:

- Sales figures
- Revenues
- Delivery times
- Service standards.

Encourage team commitment may relate to:

- Clarity of purpose, such as vision, mission, goals
- Communication
- Collaboration
- Building trust
- Team involvement.

	<i>Contingencies</i> may relate to: • Plans to deal with uncontrollable business factors • Challenges, issues, barriers. <i>Review the business plan</i> may relate to: • Quarterly reviews • Business plan cycle • Major events triggering a review, e.g. Change in market-place. <i>Performance</i> may relate to: • Market share • Sales figures • Customer satisfaction. Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Detailed knowledge of business planning techniques and formats • Knowledge of the legal, social, environmental and ethical obligations and compliance issues that affect the relevant industry context or enterprise • Detailed knowledge of the tourism and hospitality industry including current trends, structures and government policies • Research skills to identify and analyse the broad range of issues that impact on business operations. Linkages To Other Units • Develop and implement operational plans • Plan and establish systems and procedures
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- Prepare business documents
- Maintain financial standards and records
- Manage legal requirements for business compliance
- Manage physical assets and infrastructure
- Lead and manage people.

Critical Aspects of Assessment

Evidence of the following is essential:

- Demonstrated ability to undertake detailed, thorough and appropriate analyses of both internal and external business environments to provide a sound basis for business planning
- Demonstrated ability to develop and implement an integrated business plan which is implemented in a tourism or hospitality context, including:
 - Demonstrated ability to collect and analyse financial performance information
 - Demonstrated ability to plan and forecast
 - Demonstrated ability to schedule activities to meet milestones
 - Demonstrated ability to research data and trends.

Context of Assessment

This unit may be assessed on or off the job:

- Assessment should include practical demonstration of the ability to develop and implement a business plan in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge
- Assessment must relate to the individual's work area, job role and area of responsibility
- Assessment must include project or work activities that allow the candidate to respond to multiple and varying workplace issues relevant to work area, job role and area of responsibility that allow the candidate to demonstrate knowledge and awareness of developing and implementing a business plan.

	Resource Implications Training and assessment to include access to a real or simulated commercial environment in which the business plan can be implemented; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment. Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Case studies • Observation of practical candidate performance • Oral and written questions • Portfolio evidence • Problem solving • Role plays • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work. Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>									
	<table><tr><th>Key Competencies</th><th>Level</th><th>Examples</th></tr><tr><td>Collecting, organising and analysing information</td><td>3</td><td>Identify and analyse competitive activity</td></tr><tr><td>Communicating ideas and information</td><td>3</td><td>Express complex strategies in a clear and concise format</td></tr></table>	Key Competencies	Level	Examples	Collecting, organising and analysing information	3	Identify and analyse competitive activity	Communicating ideas and information	3	Express complex strategies in a clear and concise format
Key Competencies	Level	Examples								
Collecting, organising and analysing information	3	Identify and analyse competitive activity								
Communicating ideas and information	3	Express complex strategies in a clear and concise format								

	Planning and organising activities	3	Coordinate stakeholder involvement in the planning process
	Working with others and in teams	2	Devise strategies to ensure team commitment to business strategies
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	2	Create financial projections and forecasts
	Solving problems	3	Adjust strategies to respond to severe and sudden budgetary constraints
	Using technology	2	Identify and analyse the optimum use of technology to achieve business objectives

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Develop and implement a business plan D1.HCS.CL6.05 D1.HSM.CL5.06 D2.TRM.CL9.02
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. What are sources of research information?	☐	☐
2. Why is it important to involve stakeholders in the development of business plans?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. Why is it important to conduct research of the 'external environment'?	☐	☐
4. What are sources of assistance and advice?	☐	☐
5. Why is it important to conduct research of the 'internal environment'?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. What is a SWOT Analysis?	☐	☐
7. How can you find out information about competitors?	☐	☐
8. What is the purpose of an 'Executive Summary'?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. Why is it important to have objectives for a business?	☐	☐
10. What are strategies? How do they differ from objectives? Provide an example.	☐	☐
11. What are the benefits of building strategic business alliances?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. What is the difference between 'legal' and 'ethical' requirements that a business would seek to comply with?	☐	☐
13. What needs to be determined before business plan actions can be implemented?	☐	☐
14. Why is it important to involve stakeholders when developing action plans to be implemented?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. What business plan information should be communicated with stakeholders?	☐	☐
16. Explain different leadership styles that can be used to encourage team commitment to the business plan?	☐	☐
17. Why is it important to encourage staff to input to business plan?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
18. What are examples of support and resources managers can provide to support implementation actions?	☐	☐
19. Why is it important to review the business plan on a regular basis?	☐	☐
20. Why is it important to monitor and evaluate business plan implementation actions?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
21. What are types of common performance gaps in a business operation?	☐	☐
22. What are types of short term corrective action that can be taken?	☐	☐
23. What are methods that can be used to share performance related information with others?	☐	☐

Written questions

Develop and implement a business plan

D1.HCS.CL6.05

D1.HSM.CL5.06

D2.TRM.CL9.02

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. What are the research process steps?

2. What are types of relevant information that can be researched or collected?

3. What types of stakeholders may be consulted with when collecting information as part of business plan research?

4. When conducting analysis of the 'external environment' what areas would you collect information on?

5. What are types of assistance and advice that may be sought as part of the research process?

6. What are common resources that need to be reviewed as part of an 'internal environment' analysis?

7. What are examples of strengths and weaknesses that can be identified as part of a SWOT Analysis?

8. What are examples of opportunities and threats that can be identified as part of a SWOT Analysis?

9. When reviewing and analysing current and emerging competitors what information would you like to collect?

10. What is a 'Mission Statement'?

11. What is a 'Vision'?

12. What are types of objectives that may be included in a business plan?

13. Identify one objective you would have for a business and strategies that could be implemented to achieve the objective.

14. What are examples of marketing strategies?

15. What are types of strategic business alliances a tourism business may seek with other businesses?

16. What are types of legal requirements and obligations that a business must comply with?

17. What areas of business operations should have action plans?

18. What information can stakeholders provide to help decide action plans to be implemented?

19. What are stakeholder considerations when listening to a business plan proposal?

20. How can managers build mutual trust with teams?

21. What are methods used to encourage staff input to business plans?

22. What are implementation considerations when implementing actions?

23. What information needs to be identified and communicated to staff when defining and assigning roles?

24. What are examples of predictable consequences of change?

25. What influences the timing of business plan reviews?

26. What are the aims of monitoring business activities?

27. What are monitoring and evaluation methods that can be used to identify the success of business plan implementation actions?

28. What are types of performance indicators used to measure success?

29. What are types of long term corrective action that can be taken?

30. What are examples of performance related information that can be shared with stakeholders?

Answers to written questions

Develop and implement a business plan – D1.HCS.CL6.05
D1.HSM.CL5.06
D2.TRM.CL9.02

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. What are the research process steps?

- Define the problem – what do you need to know?
- Analyse the situation
- Collect information and data
- Interpret the information
- Decide on a plan of action.

2. What are types of relevant information that can be researched or collected?

- Current performance data
- Sales and contracts
- Forecasted trends and opportunities
- Available resource commitments and capacity.

3. What types of stakeholders may be consulted with when collecting information as part of business plan research?

- Customers
- Employees
- Government agencies
- Owners
- Suppliers
- Strategic alliance partners.

- 4. When conducting analysis of the 'external environment' what areas would you collect information on?**
 - Competitors
 - Economic climate
 - Customer preferences
 - E-business
 - Markets
 - Environment
 - Technology
 - Political issues
 - Legal issues
 - Social issues and trends.
- 5. What are types of assistance and advice that may be sought as part of the research process?**
 - Collection and collation of facts and information
 - Review or verification of facts
 - Legal or financial advice
 - Ensure compliance of regulations and laws
 - Issuing of permits and licences
 - Strategic planning
 - Specialist skill sets.
- 6. What are common resources that need to be reviewed as part of an 'internal environment' analysis?**
 - Location/premises
 - Occupational health and safety (OHS) resources
 - Plant/machinery
 - Raw materials
 - Refurbishment requirements
 - Staff amenities
 - Stock and supplies
 - Storage space
 - Technical equipment and software
 - Staffing & Training
 - Training materials.

7. What are examples of strengths and weaknesses that can be identified as part of a SWOT Analysis?

- Finance
- Production
- Resources
- Offerings
- Marketing
- Product life cycle
- Business relationships
- Relationships with customers
- Personnel.

8. What are examples of opportunities and threats that can be identified as part of a SWOT Analysis?

Opportunities and threats

- Political considerations
- Economic considerations
- Social considerations
- Technological considerations
- Legal considerations
- Environmental considerations.

Opportunities

- New markets
- New, up-dated or modified products or services
- Occasions where new/higher prices may be charged
- Problems being experienced by other providers which result in an opening for you
- Closure of an opposition business
- Fresh markets now available.

Threats

- Introduction of new or more severe legislation
- Opening of a new competitor
- Worsening economic conditions
- Staff shortages
- Difficulty in obtaining physical resources
- An unsettled domestic situation which scares off tourists
- Negative comparative monetary exchange rates with countries who are major clients.

9. When reviewing and analysing current and emerging competitors what information would you like to collect?

- Volume
- Price
- Territory
- Customer accounts
- Trading terms
- Market share
- Customer satisfaction.

10. What is a 'Mission Statement'?

Mission Statement is the purpose of your business, and it should state concisely your beliefs in the operation of your business.

11. What is a 'Vision'?

The Vision is the goal, or where you want your business to be in.

12. What are types of objectives that may be included in a business plan?

- Sales figures
- Revenues
- Delivery times
- Service standards
- Client numbers
- Client handling times
- Staff turnover
- Profit margins.

13. Identify one objective you would have for a business and strategies that could be implemented to achieve the objective.

Answers will be varied.

14. What are examples of marketing strategies?

Answers will be varied.

15. What are types of strategic business alliances a tourism business may seek with other businesses?

Answers will be varied.

16. What are types of legal requirements and obligations that a business must comply with?

- Registration of Business Name
- Business Licenses
- Taxation Registration
- Industrial Awards
- Medical Insurance
- Intellectual Property Registration
- Other insurances
- Pollution/environmental controls.

17. What areas of business operations should have action plans?

- Business establishment
- Operations
- Marketing
- Technology
- Human resources/labour requirements
- Management and organisational structure
- Financial plan and projections
- Quality management.

18. What information can stakeholders provide to help decide action plans to be implemented?

Answers will be varied.

19. What are stakeholder considerations when listening to a business plan proposal?

They will want to:

- Get a clear understanding of the business plan
- Ensure that all key concerns have been considered
- Understand the benefits of the business plan
- Understand how the business plan will benefit them
- Understand how the business plan will impact on them
- Understand their role in implementing the business plan
- Any potential problems identified
- Have their concerns addressed
- Be excited and reassured about the business plan.

20. How can managers build mutual trust with teams?

- Regular and effective communication
- Being supportive
- Being respectful
- Being predictable.

21. What are methods used to encourage staff input to business plans?

- Asking for ideas
- Having an 'open door' policy regarding suggestions
- Sharing ideas
- Being prepared to test new ideas
- Seeking information and ideas from non-traditional places
- Thanking people for their contributions
- Taking the time and effort to explain to someone who contributed an idea why their idea was not implemented
- Ensuring the person responsible for suggesting an effective new approach receives the credit for doing so.

22. What are implementation considerations when implementing actions?

- Compliance requirements
- Occupational safety and health (OSH)
- Legal liability exposure
- Integration with other aspects of the business
- Timing issues
- Resources
- Changes to policies and procedures
- Documentation & record keeping
- Service delivery
- Impact on organisational culture.

23. What information needs to be identified and communicated to staff when defining and assigning roles?

- Structure of the project time
- Level of responsibility and authority
- Start dates of change
- Expected completion date
- Pre-change activities including attending meetings, reading job descriptions etc.
- Activities to be performed
- Resources required to implement the plan
- Work breakdown
- Involvement of other staff
- Training to be taken
- Support mechanisms
- Expected standard of performance
- Milestones for completion
- Budgets to work within
- Methods of communication
- Making observations
- Providing feedback.

24. What are examples of predictable consequences of change?

- Disruptions to routine
- Problems with timelines
- Issues with reporting structure
- Extra support required by employees.

25. What influences the timing of business plan reviews?

- Quarterly reviews
- Business plan cycle
- Performance reports
- Major.

26. What are the aims of monitoring business activities?

- Identifying areas which are being done well and rewarding accordingly
- Identifying where areas of operations can be improved through:
 - Identification of problems
 - Understanding the cause
 - Finding suitable solutions
 - Selecting the correct solution
 - Implementing and monitoring the solution.

27. What are monitoring and evaluation methods that can be used to identify the success of business plan implementation actions?

- Reports
- Obtaining customer feedback
- Using a pretend customer
- Walking about the premises and observing what takes place
- Use of checklists
- Brainstorming sessions
- Staff input and review
- Observation
- Surveys
- Checklists
- Flowcharts
- Benchmarking.

28. What are types of performance indicators used to measure success?

- Market share
- Sales figures
- Customer satisfaction.
- Growth
- Profitability
- Turnaround times
- Output rates
- Quality rates
- Customer feedback
- Equipment usage rates
- Lead times and down times
- Compliments-complaints ratio
- Customer Satisfaction Index (CSI).

29. What are types of long term corrective action that can be taken?Management changes

- New management
- Change in orientation to service
- Setting of some new directions in relation to several other factors
- New management focus.

Organisational re-structures

- Change of personnel structure
- Elimination of positions
- New job roles
- Changes in job roles
- New knowledge or skills.

Introduction of new equipment

New equipment means:

- Possible interruptions to operations for installation
- Training for staff
- Requires that staff can explain the new equipment to customers
- Changes in job roles
- Changes in procedures
- Changes to workflow.

Recruitment practices

- Need to establish comprehensive job descriptions and job specifications
- Seeking of new knowledge and skills
- Change advertising strategy
- Revised interviewing and selection process
- Revised selection criteria.

30. What are examples of performance related information that can be shared with stakeholders?

There are many pieces of information that may be presented including, but not limited to:

- Explaining if your business plan strategy and effort work
 - Identifying the reasons why they work or not work.
 - Significant variations and the factors associated with the changes.
 - Unusual results and determine their causes.
 - Patterns and trends in consumer behaviours, and the factors that resulted in those behaviours.
 - Strengths and marketing opportunities.
 - Weaknesses and potential areas of improvement.
 - Impact / implications of the results and conclusions on performance.
-

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Develop and implement a business plan D1.HCS.CL6.05 D1.HSM.CL5.06 D2.TRM.CL9.02
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Analyse the internal and external business environment - Formulate business plans and strategies - Implement the business plan - Monitor the business plan - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Analyse the internal and external business environment		
Determine information requirements and undertake research to deliver relevant information	☐	☐
Consult with all internal and external stakeholders in the research process	☐	☐
Use research to assist in the prediction of social, political, economic and technological trends and developments	☐	☐
Identify and seek assistance and advice from appropriate experts when necessary	☐	☐
Review and analyse the existing internal resources and capabilities	☐	☐
Document and analyse business opportunities and obstacles based on valid and reliable comparative market information	☐	☐
Review and analyse current and emerging competitors for their potential impact	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 2: Formulate business plans and strategies		
Create or confirm enterprise mission, vision and purpose as the starting point for the business plan in consultation with stakeholders	☐	☐
Establish realistic, clearly stated and measurable objectives for the business	☐	☐
Develop appropriate strategies and tactics to address objectives across all areas of business operation	☐	☐
Identify and include opportunities for strategic business alliances	☐	☐
Develop all aspects of the business plan to ensure the business meets relevant legal, social, environmental and ethical obligations	☐	☐
Include appropriate action plans and evaluation processes, including key performance indicators	☐	☐
Consult with appropriate staff, management and other stakeholders to encourage support for the planning process so that all perspectives are taken into account in the development of the plan	☐	☐
Element 3: Implement the business plan		
Communicate the business objectives and content of plans in a timely manner to facilitate a clear understanding of the plan and associated activities and individual responsibilities	☐	☐
Use appropriate leadership techniques to encourage team commitment to the business plan	☐	☐
Encourage staff to provide ongoing input into the business plan	☐	☐
Implement and organise actions detailed in the plan in a cost-efficient manner and in accordance with schedule and contingencies	☐	☐
Element 4: Monitor the business plan		
Review the business plan regularly and adjust in the light of changing circumstances	☐	☐
Monitor activities detailed in the plan on an ongoing basis	☐	☐
Identify and analyse successes and performance gaps on an ongoing basis	☐	☐
Implement agreed changes to plans promptly	☐	☐
Report performance in a transparent manner to all stakeholders	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]		
Unit of competency:	Develop and implement a business plan D1.HCS.CL6.05 D1.HSM.CL5.06 D2.TRM.CL9.02		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response]</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 1: Analyse the internal and external business environment			
Determine information requirements and undertake research to deliver relevant information	☐	☐	☐
Consult with all internal and external stakeholders in the research process	☐	☐	☐
Use research to assist in the prediction of social, political, economic and technological trends and developments	☐	☐	☐
Identify and seek assistance and advice from appropriate experts when necessary	☐	☐	☐
Review and analyse the existing internal resources and capabilities	☐	☐	☐
Document and analyse business opportunities and obstacles based on valid and reliable comparative market information	☐	☐	☐
Review and analyse current and emerging competitors for their potential impact	☐	☐	☐

Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 2: Formulate business plans and strategies			
Create or confirm enterprise mission, vision and purpose as the starting point for the business plan in consultation with stakeholders	☐	☐	☐
Establish realistic, clearly stated and measurable objectives for the business	☐	☐	☐
Develop appropriate strategies and tactics to address objectives across all areas of business operation	☐	☐	☐
Identify and include opportunities for strategic business alliances	☐	☐	☐
Develop all aspects of the business plan to ensure the business meets relevant legal, social, environmental and ethical obligations	☐	☐	☐
Include appropriate action plans and evaluation processes, including key performance indicators	☐	☐	☐
Consult with appropriate staff, management and other stakeholders to encourage support for the planning process so that all perspectives are taken into account in the development of the plan	☐	☐	☐
Element 3: Implement the business plan			
Communicate the business objectives and content of plans in a timely manner to facilitate a clear understanding of the plan and associated activities and individual responsibilities	☐	☐	☐
Use appropriate leadership techniques to encourage team commitment to the business plan	☐	☐	☐
Encourage staff to provide ongoing input into the business plan	☐	☐	☐
Implement and organise actions detailed in the plan in a cost-efficient manner and in accordance with schedule and contingencies	☐	☐	☐

Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 4: Monitor the business plan			
Review the business plan regularly and adjust in the light of changing circumstances	☐	☐	☐
Monitor activities detailed in the plan on an ongoing basis	☐	☐	☐
Identify and analyse successes and performance gaps on an ongoing basis	☐	☐	☐
Implement agreed changes to plans promptly	☐	☐	☐
Report performance in a transparent manner to all stakeholders	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:

Third party signature:

Date:

Send to:

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Develop and implement a business plan	D1.HCS.CL6.05 D1.HSM.CL5.06 D2.TRM.CL9.02
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Analyse the internal and external business environment						
Determine information requirements and undertake research to deliver relevant information						
Consult with all internal and external stakeholders in the research process						
Use research to assist in the prediction of social, political, economic and technological trends and developments						
Identify and seek assistance and advice from appropriate experts when necessary						
Review and analyse the existing internal resources and capabilities						
Document and analyse business opportunities and obstacles based on valid and reliable comparative market information						
Review and analyse current and emerging competitors for their potential impact						

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 2: Formulate business plans and strategies						
Create or confirm enterprise mission, vision and purpose as the starting point for the business plan in consultation with stakeholders						
Establish realistic, clearly stated and measurable objectives for the business						
Develop appropriate strategies and tactics to address objectives across all areas of business operation						
Identify and include opportunities for strategic business alliances						
Develop all aspects of the business plan to ensure the business meets relevant legal, social, environmental and ethical obligations						
Include appropriate action plans and evaluation processes, including key performance indicators						
Consult with appropriate staff, management and other stakeholders to encourage support for the planning process so that all perspectives are taken into account in the development of the plan						

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 3: Implement the business plan						
Communicate the business objectives and content of plans in a timely manner to facilitate a clear understanding of the plan and associated activities and individual responsibilities						
Use appropriate leadership techniques to encourage team commitment to the business plan						
Encourage staff to provide ongoing input into the business plan						
Implement and organise actions detailed in the plan in a cost-efficient manner and in accordance with schedule and contingencies						

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 4: Monitor the business plan						
Review the business plan regularly and adjust in the light of changing circumstances						
Monitor activities detailed in the plan on an ongoing basis						
Identify and analyse successes and performance gaps on an ongoing basis						
Implement agreed changes to plans promptly						
Report performance in a transparent manner to all stakeholders						
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

